Farhad V. Farahani

Curriculum Vitæ

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Education

University of South Florida — Tampa, FL, USA
Ph.D. in Economics, expected May 2028 — *Aug 2023 – Present*
M.A. in Economics (Summer 2026)
Dissertation Committee: Padmaja Ayyagari (Chair), Andrei Barbos, Rodrigo Pinto, Kenneth Whaley, Barton Willage (external, University of Delaware)

Iran University of Science and Technology — Tehran, Iran
M.Sc. in Economics, Economic Systems Planning (GPA 3.7/4) — *Sep 2018 – Jan 2022*
Thesis: "Big Five Personality Traits and Their Influence on Investment Fund Management in Iran"
Committee: Y. Sobhani-Fard, A. Rafie

Allameh Tabataba'i University — Tehran, Iran
B.Sc. in Economics, Industrial & Development Economics — *Sep 2014 – Jul 2018*

Research Interests

Primary: Health Economics; Health Policy (Medicaid & Medicare); Applied Microeconometrics.
Secondary: Labor Economics; Policy Evaluation; Behavioral Economics.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed

- Firoozabadi, S., Ansari, M., & Farahani, F. V. (2024). *Crude Oil Trend Prediction During COVID-19: Machine Learning with Randomized Search and Bayesian Optimization.* European Journal of Business and Management Research, 9(3).

Job Market Paper

- *Helping Hands, Healthier Infants: The Effect of Medicaid Doula Coverage Mandates on Birth Outcomes.* 2026.

  Many U.S. states now pay for doula care through Medicaid, hoping to improve infant health and narrow racial gaps in birth outcomes. I evaluate these mandates using their staggered 2021–2024 rollout, 32.1 million births from CDC WONDER (2016–2024), and a new measure of the state doula workforce built from the national provider registry. On average, I find no detectable effect on low birth weight. The effect concentrates among Black mothers, the group at greatest risk: in states with the longest exposure, their low-birth-weight rate falls by about 0.5 percentage points (about 5% of the baseline), with flat pretrends. Two-stage least squares shows that coverage roughly doubles the doula workforce. Methods: staggered difference-in-differences (Callaway & Sant'Anna), 2SLS/IV, wild-cluster-bootstrap inference.

Working Papers

- *Returns to U.S. and Foreign Experience among Immigrant Men: Evidence from IPUMS Microdata.* 2025. arXiv:2512.18827.

  U.S. experience yields higher wage returns than foreign experience, with returns rising in English proficiency. Data: IPUMS (Census/ACS). Methods: Mincer wage regressions with fixed effects.

Work in Progress

- *The Effect of Criminal-Justice Reform on Crime: Evidence from California's Proposition 47.* With Rodrigo Pinto.
- *Domestic Workers' Bills of Rights and Labor-Market Outcomes in the United States.*

  Preliminary results indicate higher wages and increased formalization. Data: Current Population Survey. Methods: DiD, two-way fixed effects, event study (staggered adoption).

Conference Presentations

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Houston, TX — *Helping Hands, Healthier Infants* (scheduled) Nov 2026

Media Coverage

"States With Medicaid Coverage of Doulas Show Signs of Healthier Babies" — interview, *Spotlight on Poverty and Opportunity* Oct 2026

Teaching Experience

University of South Florida Aug 2023 – Present
Instructor of Record — Principles of Macroeconomics (ECO 2013), Fall 2025, Spring 2026 & Fall 2026.
47 students; overall instructor rating 4.0/5 (Fall 2025), 4.2/5 (Spring 2026).
Teaching Assistant — Intermediate Price Theory, Microeconomic Principles, Macroeconomic Principles, Development Economics, Game Theory.

Iran University of Science and Technology Sep 2019 – Feb 2021
Teaching Assistant — Microeconomics I; designed assignments, quizzes, and tutorials.

Allameh Tabataba'i University Sep 2015 – Jul 2018
Teaching Assistant — Mathematics I; tutorials and problem sessions.

Technical Skills

Languages & Software: Python, R, Julia, MATLAB, Stata, EViews.
Typesetting & Tools: LaTeX, Jupyter, RStudio, Git, VS Code, MS Office.

Honors and Awards

Seminar Grant, Dept. of Economics, USF — presentation at the Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Houston, TX 2026
Graduate Assistantship, University of South Florida 2023 – Present
Top-ranked by GPA among graduate economics students, IUST 2021
Ranked 80th of ∼11,000, National Graduate Economics Entrance Exam, Iran 2018

Graduate Coursework

Microeconomics I–II (incl. Game Theory), Macroeconomics I–II, Mathematical Economics I–II, Econometrics I–III, Economics of Health Care I–II, Labor Economics, Economic Policy Analysis, Behavioral Economics, Mathematical Programming.

References

Padmaja Ayyagari (Advisor), Associate Professor, Dept. of Economics, USF · padmajaa@usf.edu
Andrei Barbos, Professor, Dept. of Economics, USF · abarbos@usf.edu
Rodrigo Pinto, Assistant Professor, Dept. of Economics, USF · rodrigopinto@usf.edu

Joel Melendez-Lugo (Teaching Reference), Assistant Professor of Instruction, Dept. of Economics, USF · jmelendezlugo@usf.edu